

SPECIAL EFFECTS

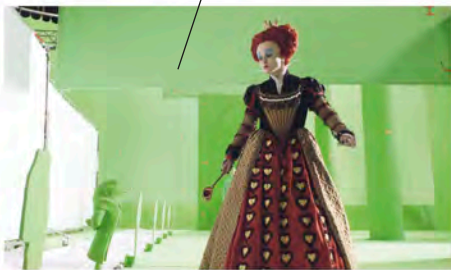
Have you ever wondered how alien worlds are filmed, or how actors and actresses survive death-defying leaps? These amazing events are not real, they are created by special effects. With CGI (computer-generated imagery), clever camera work, and special equipment, such as wind machines, film directors can make us believe that what we are seeing is real. These tricks of the trade are used when shooting the action in the normal way would be too expensive, too dangerous, or just impossible!



Size isn't everything

This tiny, detailed model of a Y-wing spaceship appeared in *Return of the Jedi*. On screen it looked big enough to carry people!

Green screen



Virtual reality

Green screens are an important part of making special effects for television or film. The process is called chroma-key and it uses technology to superimpose actors and props onto a virtual background.

A wind machine can make a gentle breeze or a howling gale.

Cue

Filmmakers can't wait for the right weather.

In this scene from *The Mosquito Coast*, giant fans whipped up the waves that battered the boat.

